Competitor Support Services

Overview

Multiple support services have been deployed to help provide competitors with the right resources to be successful during a competition. These services are not scored, are out of scope for the Red Team, and are supported during competitions. If these support services are disrupted, teams should report that immediately so that work can begin on restoring service to those affected.

The currently deployed support services are summarized as follows:

- Centralized Authentication
- Document Collaboration and File Sharing
- Competition Chat System
- Support Ticketing System

Support service status can be viewed at https://status.ccdc.events/ at any time. Support services are checked every couple of minutes, so there may be a slight delay if a support service is down. This can be a useful tool in initial troubleshooting.

Support service monitoring should notify the Black Team (operations) to suspected issues. Notification from competitors is always welcome through Zoom, Chat, Support Ticket, or any other means available.

Centralized Authentication

An authentik[1] server has been deployed to handle authentication for many of the support services provided during a competition. This prevents competitors from having to keep track of individual accounts for each support service, and provides a smoother overall login experience. The authentication site can also be used as a sort of home page, even if it may not provide authentication to that support service.

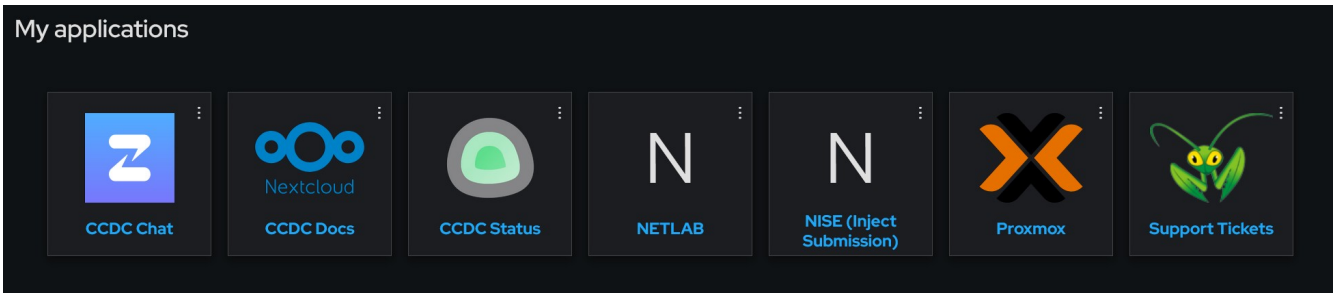
The primary way of accessing the authentication system is by going to https://auth.ccdc.events/ in any web browser. From there a user may login, and click on any of the available links. You should be given a login that is the same as the NISE platform, with a username in the format of *teamXX[a-i]*.

NOTE: You may not see all of the available applications when you first login. Some applications do not open up until a set point in the event. For example, most applications generally open 30 minutes prior

1 https://goauthentik.io/

to the scheduled drop flag. These times are subject to change, but please ask for help if you believe there is an issue.

Once logged in, you should see a list of applications similar to the picture below. Click on any of the icons to launch that application. Some applications may log you in automatically, some may require interaction, and some may require a separate login.



Document Collaboration and File Sharing

A Nextcloud[2] server has been deployed, in conjunction with a Collabora Online[3] system, to provide real-time document editing for competitors. For basic instructions on using the Nextcloud environment, please reference the How-To document at https://s.ccdc.events/NextcloudHowTo or a distributed PDF version.

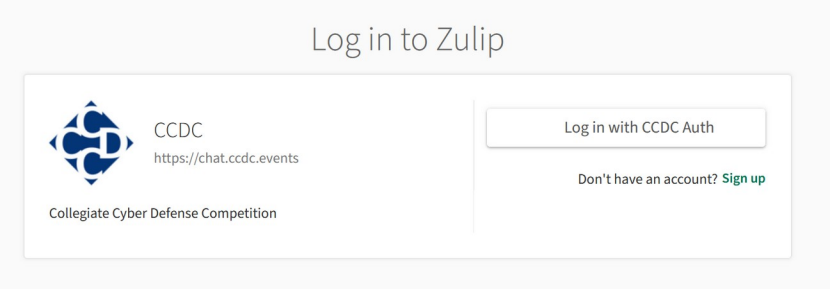
Accessing Nextcloud can be done from authentik, or by visiting https://docs.ccdc.events/ in a web browser.

Competition Chat System

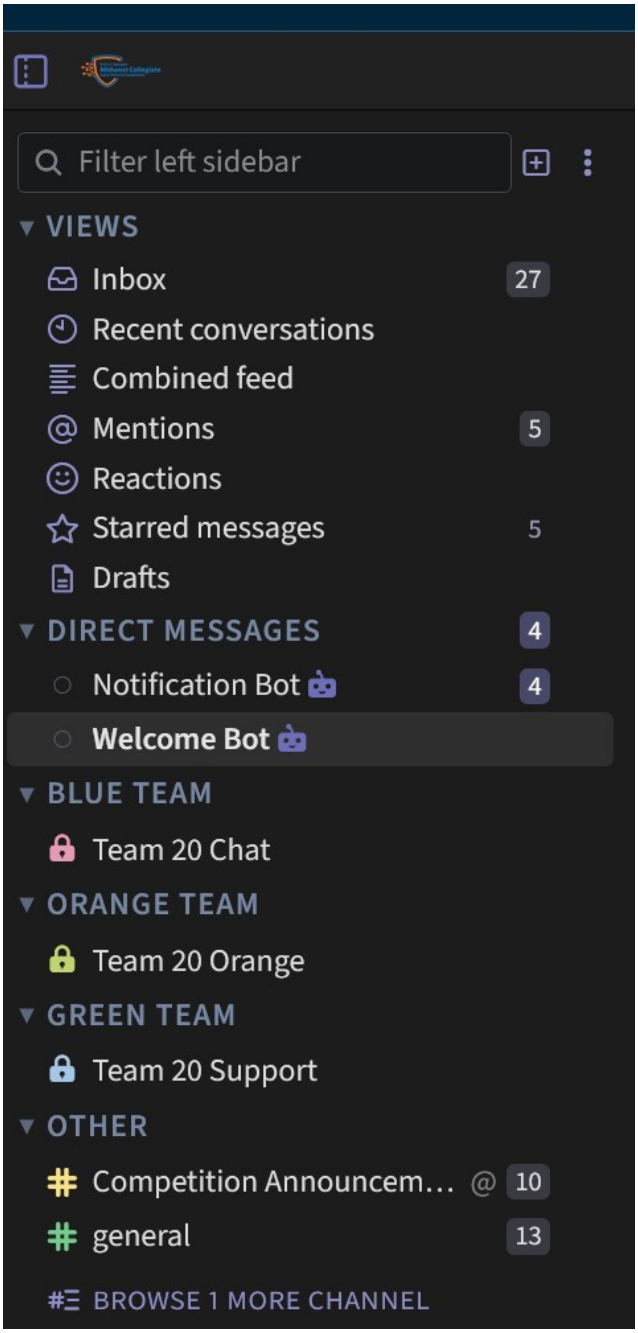
A Zulip[4] chat server has been deployed to assist teams with internal communications, as well as communicating with the various other groups supporting a competition. Access to the chat system can be through authentik, or by visiting https://chat.ccdc.events/ in a web browser.

On your first visit, you will be asked to log in, or sign up. All users should have accounts provisioned prior to the event, so you should click “Log in with CCDC Auth”.

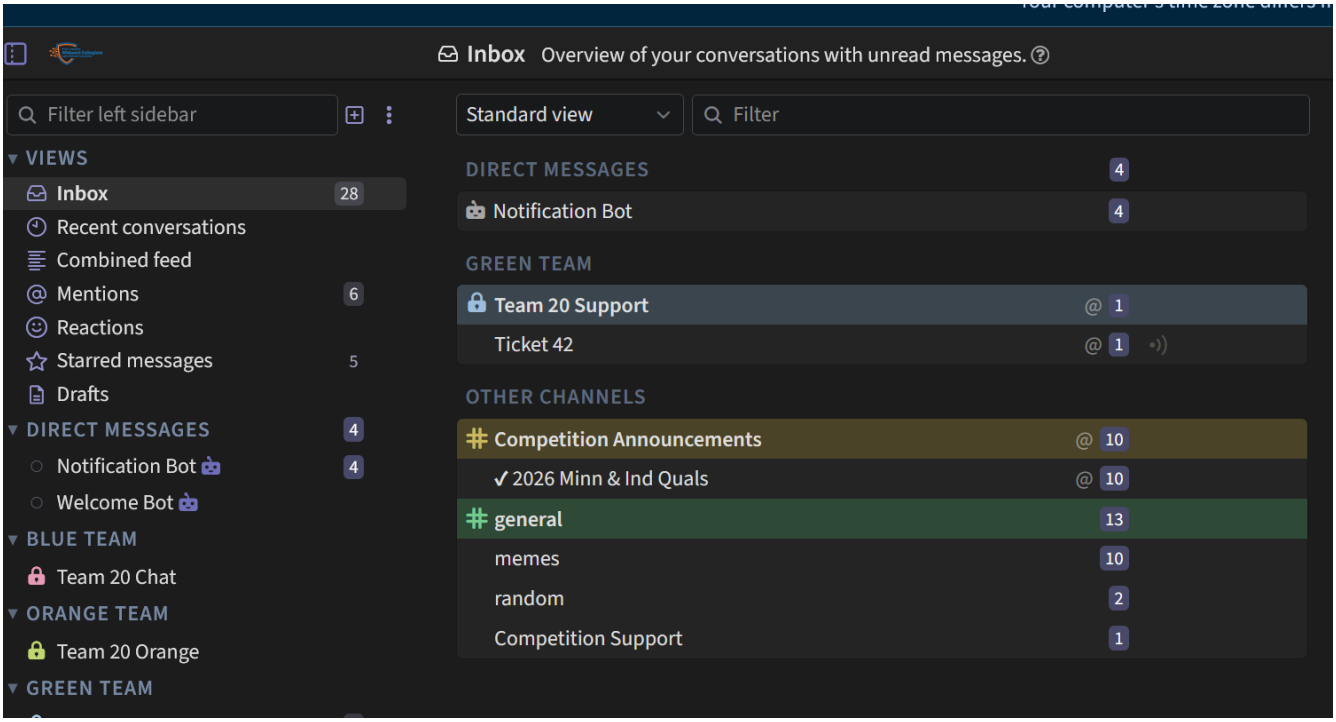
2 https://nextcloud.com/
3 https://www.collaboraonline.com/code/
4 https://zulip.com/



When you first login to chat you should familiarize yourself with the layout. The left hand side lists all the channels that you are subscribed to. You should see your team's blue chat, your team's green chat, your team's orange chat, competition announcements, and general.



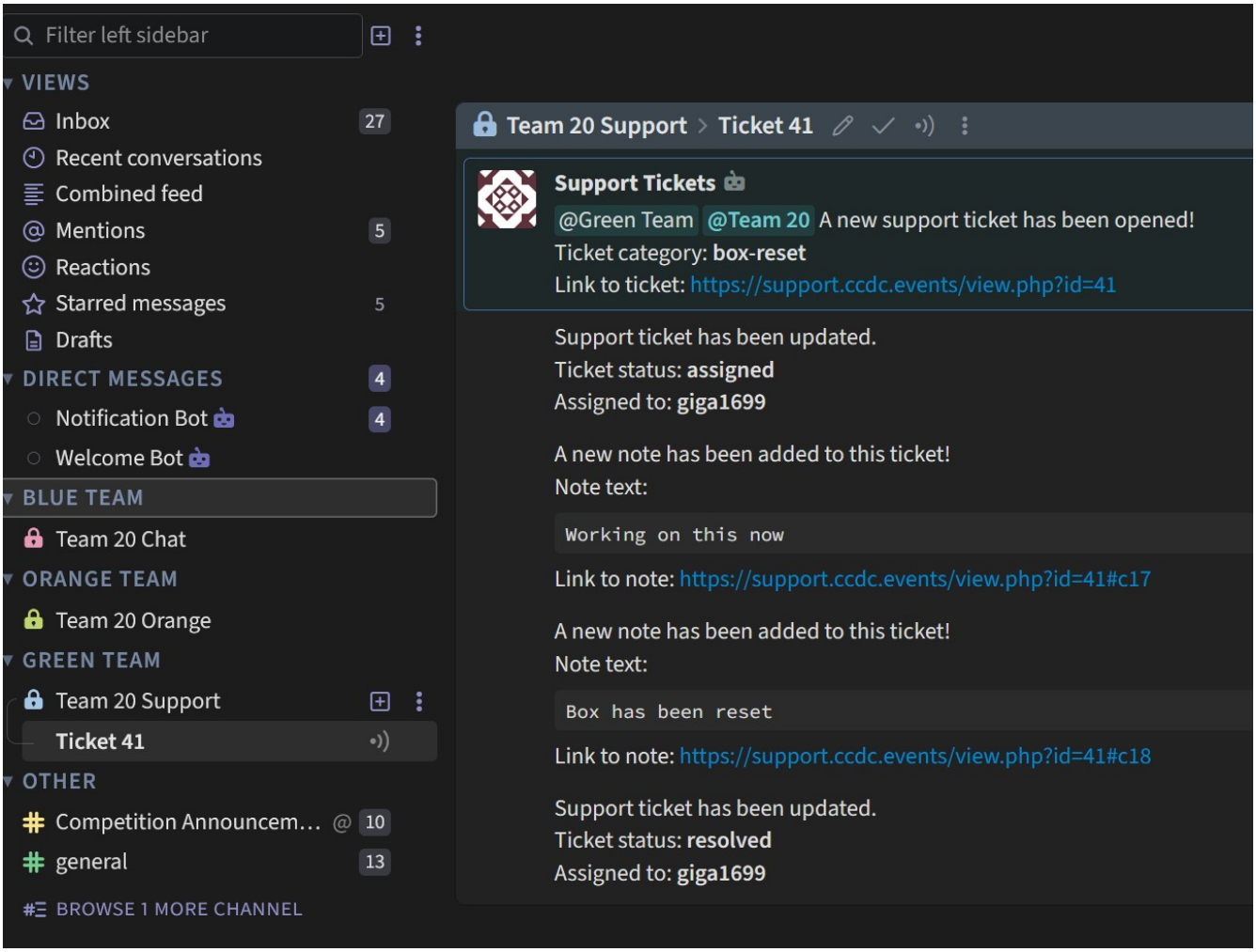
The inbox view will show you a summary of all channels that have unread messages.



Within each channel, conversations are split into “topics”. There is no limit to the number of topics per channel.

The Blue Team chat is meant for internal communications for competitors. The only users authorized to post in those channels are the blue teams, and select system administrators. White Team is authorized read-only access to the team chats for monitoring the competitors, and helping to keep things fair across the board. Image pasting inside the chat is permitted.

The Green Team chat is the primary way to discuss system issues, and receive immediate updates on tickets. When a new ticket is opened for your team, you should receive a notice in this channel with a new topic that has the ticket number. A link to the support ticket should be presented. Every time the ticket is updated, you should receive a new notification within chat.



NOTE: Chat messages are not transferred to the ticketing system. If you need to provide an update to the ticket, and the Green Team isn't engaging in the chat, please submit a note on the actual ticket.

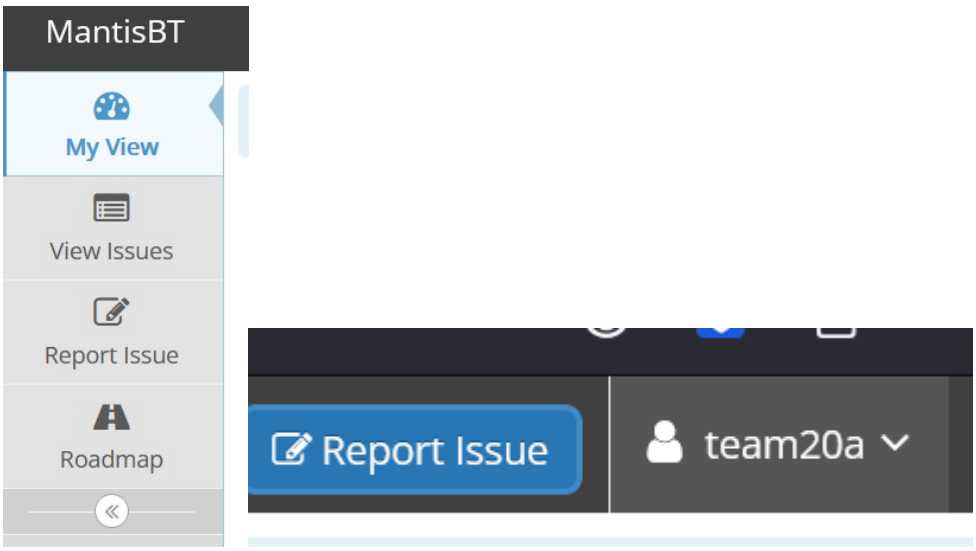
The Orange Team channel would be used to interact with any Orange Team members during a competition. You may need to have a team member monitoring that chat through an entire event. Please refer to the Team Pack for potential indications on the presence of Orange Team for an event.

Support Ticketing System

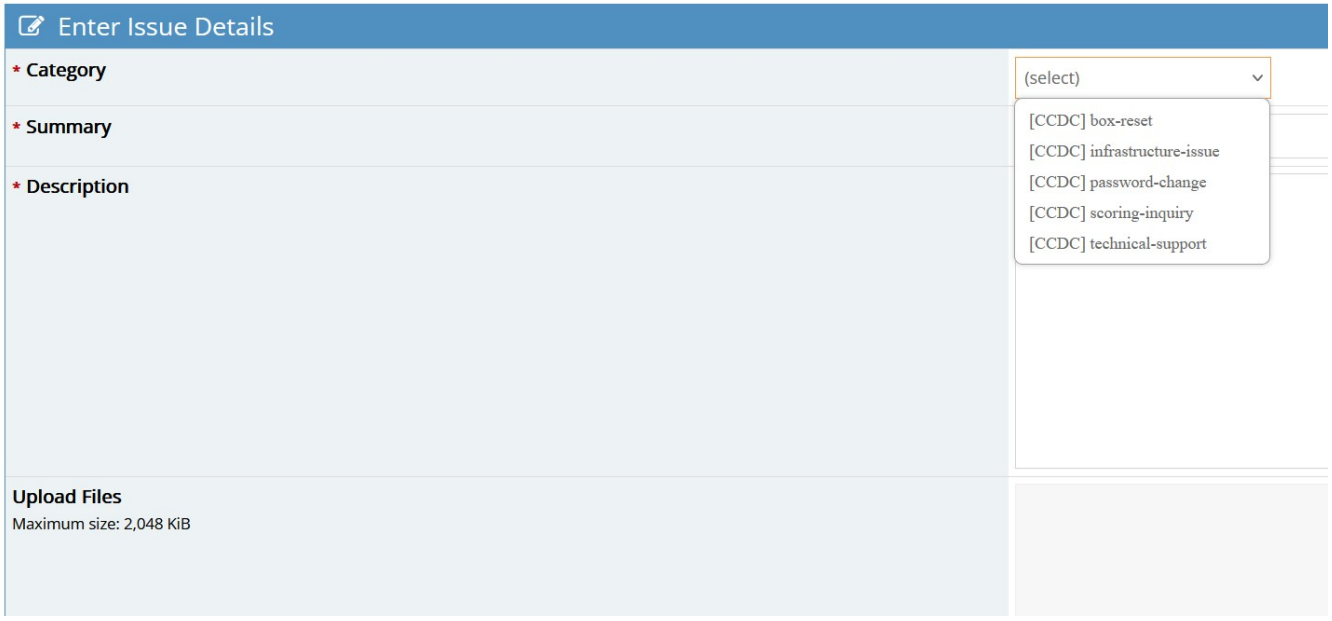
A MantisBT[5] ticketing system has been setup to assist with the tracking of various requests and issues during an event. Access to the system can be accomplished through the authentik home page, or by going to https://support.ccdc.events/ within a browser.

When you go to the ticket system, you should be automatically logged in, and presented with the main page. To submit a ticket, click "Report issue" in the top right corner of the page, or on the left side of the screen.

5 https://mantisbt.org/



Select the appropriate category for the ticket, provide a short summary, and a detailed description of the request/issue. You can attach files by pasting, dragging/dropping, or selecting them by clicking on the upload cloud icon.



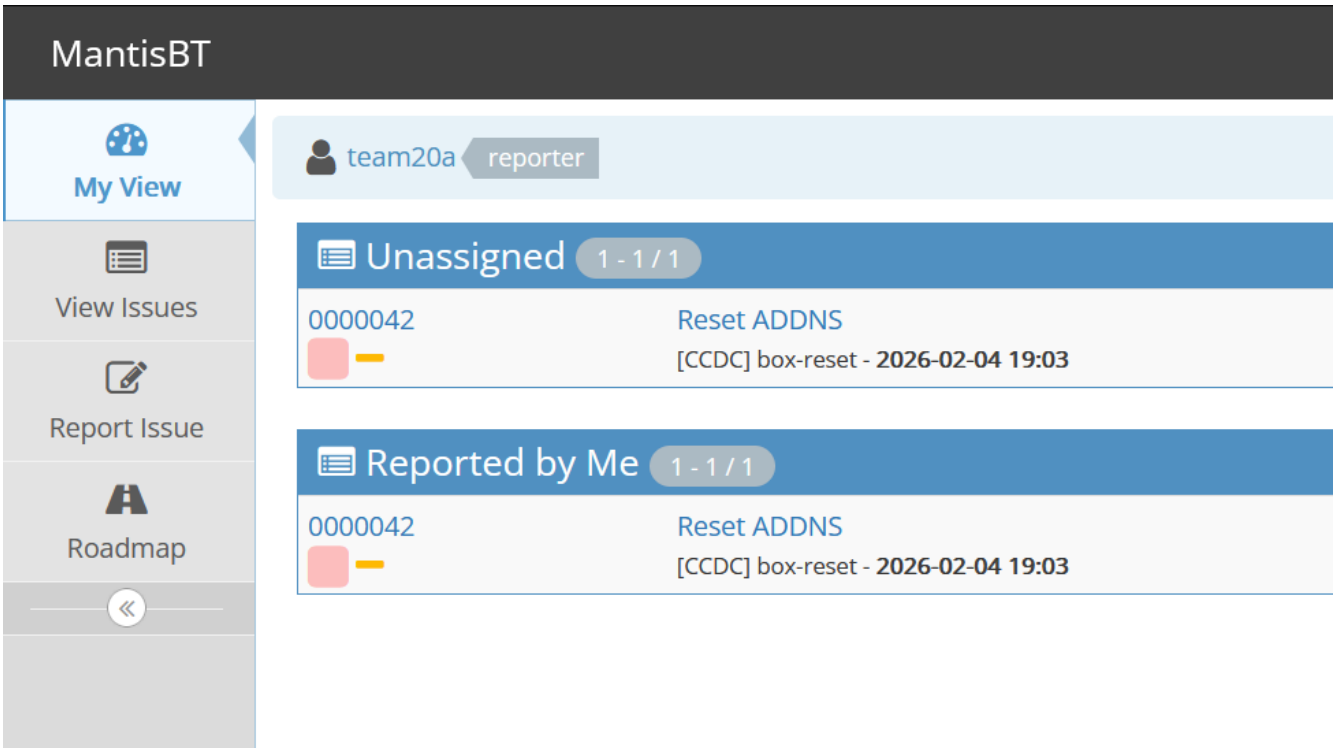
The categories available are described as follows:

- box-reset: Request a reset/scrub of a competition VM back to its initial state at the start of the competition.
- infrastructure-issue: Issues with core infrastructure/services such as Chat, Nextcloud, NISE, NETLAB access, etc.
- password-change: Request that certain passwords be changed within the scoring engine. Please reference any password change policy injects on the proper way to submit a request.
- scoring-inquiry: Request that the scoring team provide some feedback on why a service is

showing as down in the scoring engine.

- technical-support: Request support, if available, with a competition VM.

On the support homepage you may see unassigned tickets for your team, as well as tickets your user account has opened. If you wish to see all tickets for your team, click on “View Issues” on the left side of the screen.



You can click into any ticket to check on the status, or to provide an update in the form of a note.

